



Broadcom vs Qualcomm

Broadcom wants its choice of board members at Qualcomm as it fights to acquire the rival chipmaker. <http://digit.in/QCmvsBCM>



Amazon buys Blink

Blink, the wire-free home monitoring system, has been acquired by Amazon in a bid to beef up its connected home lineup. <http://digit.in/AmznBlink>

Razer BlackWidow Chroma V2

Minor upgrades to an already well-built keyboard



Price
₹14,999



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azer's BlackWidow Chroma V2 adds a set of upgrades. The

font has a more professional look. It's suitable for both gamers and casual users. The sturdy plastic body didn't show any flex, and it will be able to take a beating. The new matte coating on the chassis keep oil stains away and even though the keycaps also have a similar coating, they don't do a good enough job. Speaking of keycaps, the stem isn't thick enough and it doesn't provide a snug fit on the switches. This resulted in the keycaps, apart from the alphabets, coming off after some rigorous typing. A cushioned wrist rest (finally!) attaches with the keyboard through magnets.

Our review unit had the Razer Green switches which are tactile and clicky similar to Cherry MX Blues. This keyboard also comes in the Orange and Yellow switch variants. The extra buttons on the left are to assign macros and shortcuts. At this price range, it's natural to expect dedicated multimedia buttons which is absent on this keyboard. If that's a deal breaker for you, then you could go for the Corsair K70 Lux RGB or K95 Platinum (more expensive). And if RGB isn't something you crave for, the HyperX Alloy Elite is a great choice at a much lower price.

—Abhijit Dey

SPECIFICATIONS

KEYBOARD SIZE: Standard, Numpad included | KEYBOARD BACKLIGHTING: RGB LED | SWITCH TYPE: Mechanical (Razer Green 80-million lifecycle) | POLLING RATE: 1,000Hz (1 ms) | KEY-ROLLOVER: N-key rollover | INTERFACE: USB 2.0 | DIMENSIONS: Width - 47.5 cm, Length - 17.1 cm, HEIGHT - 3.9 cm | CABLE LENGTH: 2m | WEIGHT: 1.5 kg

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Xiaomi Redmi 5A 32 GB

Commodifying smartphones

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he smartphone has slowly become a commodity and there's no going back from it. If you weren't quite sure about that yet, the Xiaomi Redmi 5A is all the proof you need. It's the best entry-level smartphone you can buy today, but it's almost literally a carbon copy of its predecessor, the Redmi 4A. It's made of plastic, with a metal-like finish to it. It's compact and is nicely suited for single-handed use. The good thing is, the Redmi 5A's camera focuses quite fast for a budget device, and image processing times are quite low as well. It slows down drastically in HDR, but we're assuming entry-level buyers aren't going to shoot many HDR photos either.

Xiaomi may have chosen a smaller battery this time, but that doesn't really change the battery life. The Redmi 5A lasted between dusk to dawn on a single charge quite easily. The phone lasted 9 hours and 54 minutes on PC Mark's Work 2.0 battery test, which puts it in the above average segment on our tests. If you're buying an entry-level smartphone, the Redmi 5A is the phone to buy. There's no question about it. But here's the catch. Xiaomi is selling the 16GB variant of this phone at ₹5,999 (and ₹4,999 for the first 5 million units). That's a phone we wouldn't recommend to anyone.

—Prasid Banerjee



Price
₹6,999



FEATURE.....68
PERFORMANCE.....70
VALUE.....85
DESIGN.....77

SPECIFICATIONS

SOC: Snapdragon 425 | GPU: Adreno 308 | OS: Android 7.1.2 (Nougat) | CARD SLOT: microSD (up to 256 GB) | SIZE: 5.0 inches | RESOLUTION: 720 x 1280 pixels | CAMERA PRIMARY: 13 MP (f/2.2) | CAMERA SECONDARY: 5 MP (f/2.0).

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